

FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 19

LOUISIANA

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — a cross-location dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Louisiana's family courts and child-welfare system.

67

LOUISIANA FAMILIES ON RECORD · 121 CHILDREN IMPACTED · 24 MONTHS MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING TIME

DATA AS OF
OCTOBER 20, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
36 OF 64

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS · LOUISIANA

A name appears below only after 3 or more independent families have named the same actor in Louisiana. Submitter names, emails, and contact details are never published. Comments below are direct family reports — one per family — with all identifying information removed.

Terri Campesta

CUSTODY EVALUATOR · PLAQUEMINES · **6 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Husband at the time hurt the children and me. I provided evidence of bruises on the children and when he tried to strangle me and my daughter disclosed sexual abuse by her father. I called 911 on him twice. Terri Campesta recommended the father get sole custody and he did."*

> *"Custody evaluation was biased, she met with the father 12 times and with the mother three, she ignored Mother's report regarding the father's child pornography addiction, she recommended sole custody to the father"*

> *"She lied about my mom and it's because my dad told her iles and she believed him. My dad molested me and she wrote a report that said I have to live with him and I don't get to see my mom now."*

> *"Falsified information, ignored evidence, violated confidentiality laws, conducted evaluation outside their area of competence, accepted bribes, knowlingly made false statements to the court"*

> *"Did not believe the child's disclosures of sexual abuse even though substantiated by CPS, refused to speak to child's therapist"*

> *"Became romantically involved with my ex during court case. Lied about me to give him sole custody"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/la-terri-campesta/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Michael Clement

JUDGE · PLAQUEMINES · **5 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"The judge made a ruling that I had to live with my dad who molested me. I know there is evidence, I had to talk to the police and I was in therapy so they had to have said something but it didn't matter."*

> *"Ignored evidence from the child's teacher about sexual abuse disclosure, then refused her affidavit after refusing to allow her to testify"*

> *"Ignored evidence, allowed opposing counsel to call witnesses you never spoke with child or mother, no best interest factors in ruling."*

> *"Unethical, endgangered children, Ignored evidence, improper courtroom behavior, bias, retaliatory conduct, improper use of authority"*

> *"Denied my evidence that perjured ex's witnesses, refused to allow my professionals to testify"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/la-michael-clement/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Public threshold rule: Names are grouped conservatively by normalized spelling, role, and location. Common titles, punctuation, casing, and middle initials collapse together. Close misspellings are not auto-merged without admin review. Only family-direct submissions count toward the public threshold.

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

LOUISIANA AT A GLANCE.

Across 67 Louisiana families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED
121
67 of 67 families reported child counts

MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN
$193,450
median across 34 families reporting 3+ categories

MEDIAN MONTHS LOST
24
of parenting time

WENT PRO SE
52.2%
35 of 67 who answered; 26 of 67 ran out of money

SUBMISSIONS	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN	COUNTIES REPRESENTED
67	1.8	67 of 67	36

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Louisiana families — and families across every represented location — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

03 THE COST OF LOUISIANA FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	46	$22,500	$65,509	$3,013,405
Lost Wages	38	$14,000	$77,807	$2,956,677
Other Court Fees	27	$3,500	$9,192	$248,171
Therapy / Evaluations	31	$3,000	$6,414	$198,841
Reunification Services	22	$500	$1,779	$39,136
GAL Fees	21	$2,000	$2,291	$48,101
Asset Loss [1]	29	$40,000	—	—
Median Family Burden (34 families reporting 3+ categories)	—	$193,450	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least $1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median ($40,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost	24	2 yrs
Mean months lost	38	3.2 yrs
Total across all families	1,969	164.1 yrs

04 WHO IS REPORTING · LOUISIANA

Most families documenting in Louisiana are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children. Percentages below use only families who answered that specific topic.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed	30	45%
Not provided	12	18%
Case closed: within last 2 years	8	12%
Active case: progress being made	5	7%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago	5	7%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Family Court Only	36	54%
Both Family Court and CPS	21	31%
Unknown	6	9%
CPS Only	4	6%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years	19	28%
5 – 10 years	18	27%
3 – 5 years	13	19%
6 months – 1 year	7	10%
Over 10 years	6	9%

CUSTODY STATUS

Visitation Only	21	31%
No Contact / Total Loss of Access	20	30%
50/50 Joint	11	16%
Children in Foster Care	10	15%
Adopted Out (Rights Terminated)	3	4%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Plaquemines	5	9%
Jefferson	4	7%
Calcasieu	3	5%
St Tammany	3	5%
Ouachita	3	5%
Livingston Parish	2	4%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)	28	42%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)	13	19%
Other: (Short answer)	6	9%
Other	5	7%
High Conflict Divorce	5	7%

05 PARENT VOICES — LOUISIANA

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Louisiana comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.

> *This system has destroyed safety for my children and myself. They've caused us to fight for basic human decency while they have IGNORED our cries!*
>
> — MOLLY

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

St Tammany Parish is so corrupt and uses the good ole boy system. I wasn't fighting my ex. I was fighting STP who took my children with no due process to fund themselves. Why is family court THE ONLY COURT who is funded by you and me

— LOUISIANA PARENT · JENNIFER

MORE VOICES FROM LOUISIANA

Destroyed my faith in a fair legal system

— AMY

Changed my view of the legal system. It has ripped an entire family apart and forever changed my relationship with not only my kids but everyone I know.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Judge Michael Clement ignored evidence that the father abused our two children and he awarded the father sole custody when he only had supervised visitation for the past three years. Judge Clement also ignored the documented history of domestic violence, photographs, 911 calls [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed myself and my daughters life stripping away my ability to pay my house note, bills and necessities with illegal child support exceeding the legal limit and without a legal hearing , ignored all evidence of child abuse and sided with the perpetrators regardless of [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *My ex wife stole my children during my custody period then made false accusations against me. CPS and Law Enforcement in three different states determined everything was unfounded but the judge still awarded temporary custody and there is no end in site as opposing counsel's [...]*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

My children mean the world to me, and the system failed me. Losing them has completely broken me... mentally, finally, emotionally. I'll never be able to get back what's been stolen from me- time- valuable time with my kids.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court specifically judge Michael Clement ruled against a child's safety and forced her to live with her abuser.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

"What was supposed to protect my family instead fractured it—turning unproven allegations into real consequences for me and my children."

— PEPPER

EBR family court has. Profited off of Children's lives being sold here in Baton Rouge to the highest bidder ever since I was a child in this same system. Unethical, unconstitutional, no rights of due process, false imprisonment, deprivation of equal protection clause, civil [...]

— PRISCILLA

Destroyed my marriage by painting us against each other and promising him ine things like custody and creating lies to start troubles. Thry dont want families together they want to destroy lives. Theres nonreunification. The system is designed one way. They win. And we are [...]

— LAUREN

This system has ripped my family apart. Now, I grieve the loss of my children while they are still living.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My childhood was destroyed by the courts, when I grew up and finally stood up for myself and reported my abuse, my abuser came for my kids his grandkids. The system was completely Weaponized against me. I would show up for court and be arrested for a seatbelt ticket from a [...]

— CAREY

Forced us to communicate with abuser making me feel like he still has control. The kids hate going to his home (our home) but he obviously owns more...

— CHASITY

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Destroyed my family. Ruined our lives.*
>
> — LAUREN

In 2022, while married, my husband abused our children and tried strangling me. I called 911 two times. I showed the custody evaluator and the judge evidence and the children disclosed the abuse they suffered. My daughter also disclosed sexual abuse by the father to the custody [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

kidnapped our child and gave him to our abuser

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

it has destroyed me and my fiance I have lost time with my child I'll never get back it has done a whole lot to us

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Family court has ruined my life!

— STEVEN

The system in Livingston Parish Louisiana destroyed my marriage, my three children, and my entire life for many years! The pain does not go away! Especially when I see how mentally, emotionally, and physically messed up my children are today!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has destroy my entire family, my soul is gone, my heart is literally broken

— ANGIE

The system has worked together fraudulently to remove my son . Orleans Parish Civil Court Family and Succession. They're all working together with the system judges, lawyers, opposing spouse. I was threatened with jail time and contempt of court. My son was institutionalized an [...]

— TERRELL

This system has unnecessarily destroyed my relationship with my parents and other extended family. Spreading lies and misinformation, taking my children BECAUSE I DIDNT KNOW ANYBODY TO BE A SAFETY PERSON AND COME TO MY HOME EVERYDAY!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *the court made me live with my dad who sexually molested me and the judge took me away from my mom who I love and was safe with her.*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system worked with the father to take my children away from their loving mother because father hates mom.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Stole everything, my life, my sanity, my happiness. Destroyed everything.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Left me suicidal and wishing I could have taken matters in hand in the beginning and never gotten involved with the legal system. One or two good come to Jesus meetings and we all could have moved on happily.

— KELLY

I have experienced emotional, financial, legal, and mental abuse with coercive control over my child. More importantly my child has experienced emotional and mental abuse from the same situation.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Make it make sense I can't make this shit yo if I tried

— NICOLE

Has ripped us apart. I proved I was a fit parent. And desperately wanted my son. They bullied and lied to me. Then adopted him to his foster parents withing 3 to 4 months later. Then put him into a mental hospit.

— LORYN

Made it to easy to get divorced. And to beneficial to the woman. The system is here to screw over the father.

— CHRISTOPHER

It has casued me to lose custody of my son. An my marriage is coming to an end behind this as well.

— CHRISTINE

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Accusation of Parent alienation*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

Walking through family court felt less like seeking protection and more like trying to survive a system that abuses protective parents. I entered the process believing the truth alone would be enough, and left realizing how complicated and devastating these cases can become for [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

it has damn never killed me time I will never get back. put stuff on me all most un respable to complete it's sad sick it's a night near in my dreams at night scared to enjoy life they watching trying to find something on me

— TIFFANY

The family has robbed my children not only of their mother and extended family, but their siblings. They've missed out on so much and have been nonstop brainwashed

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This beyond “cruel” situation, (instead) had “weaponized” our Injury Trial “Settlement”, to deny my son his essential “continuing care”, that he continued (for years) to be assured to receive, that suddenly instead has expedited his expiration date!

— RUSSELL

This system has beaten and destroyed the mental health of 6 very healthy people before them. I have had to watch my babies beg me to save them and couldn’t do anything. My son is mad and blamed me for leaving because he doesn’t understand. I went from 2 times a week visits to [...]

— TIFFANIE NICOLE

The last time I saw my daughters was on their first day of preschool and kindergarten, my ex (a bailiff) filed an unjust emergency order. They are now 21 years old and 22 years old.

— AMBER

43 Louisiana parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 40 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — LOUISIANA

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Louisiana families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

> St Tammany Parish is so corrupt and uses the good ole boy system. I wasn't fighting my ex. I was fighting STP who took my children with no due process to fund themselves. Why is family court THE ONLY COURT who is funded by you and me
>
> — JENNIFER

> This system has destroyed safety for my children and myself. They've caused us to fight for basic human decency while they have IGNORED our cries!
>
> — MOLLY

> Destroyed my faith in a fair legal system
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> Changed my view of the legal system. It has ripped an entire family apart and forever changed my relationship with not only my kids but everyone I know.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Judge Michael Clement ignored evidence that the father abused our two children and he awarded the father sole custody when he only had supervised visitation for the past three years. Judge Clement also ignored the documented history of domestic violence, photographs, 911 calls, and expert testimony. This court has destroyed two children's lives.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Destroyed myself and my daughters life stripping away my ability to pay my house note, bills and necessities with illegal child support exceeding the legal limit and without a legal hearing , ignored all evidence of child abuse and sided with the perpetrators regardless of evidence against them leaving my kids in harms way and my kids did and still receive abuse and injuries ignored by all state actors causing further pain and suffering for them
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

My ex wife stole my children during my custody period then made false accusations against me. CPS and Law Enforcement in three different states determined everything was unfounded but the judge still awarded temporary custody and there is no end in site as opposing counsel's mistakes have delayed court almost a full year.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My children mean the world to me, and the system failed me. Losing them has completely broken me... mentally, finally, emotionally. I'll never be able to get back what's been stolen from me- time- valuable time with my kids.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court specifically judge Michael Clement ruled against a child's safety and forced her to live with her abuser.

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"What was supposed to protect my family instead fractured it—turning unproven allegations into real consequences for me and my children."

— PEPPER

EBR family court has. Profited off of Children's lives being sold here in Baton Rouge to the highest bidder ever since I was a child in this same system. Unethical, unconstitutional, no rights of due process, false imprisonment, deprivation of equal protection clause, civil rights, fundamental right as a parent in child's rearing, post separation family violence relief act, improper representation and undue influence.

— PRISCILLA

Destroyed my marriage by painting us against each other and promising him ine things like custody and creating lies to start troubles. Thry dont want families together they want to destroy lives. Theres nonreunification. The system is designed one way. They win. And we are silenced. Enough is enough. They've denied my babynand me precious moments ill never get back. Ill never stop fighting against these people we need justice and accountability. This is no okay to rip children away!!!

— LAUREN

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> This system has ripped my family apart. Now, I grieve the loss of my children while they are still living.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> My childhood was destroyed by the courts, when I grew up and finally stood up for myself and reported my abuse, my abuser came for my kids his grandkids. The system was completely Weaponized against me. I would show up for court and be arrested for a seatbelt ticket from a decade ago. I was held without bail multiple times.
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> Destroyed my family. Ruined our lives.
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> — LAUREN

> In 2022, while married, my husband abused our children and tried strangling me. I called 911 two times. I showed the custody evaluator and the judge evidence and the children disclosed the abuse they suffered. My daughter also disclosed sexual abuse by the father to the custody evaluator. The father hired Alicia Pellegrin to write a report. Alicia Pellegrin never met with the children or with me and she diagnosed parental alienation. She recommended the father get sole custody. The judge awarded the father sole custody.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> kidnapped our child and gave him to our abuser
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

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> The system has worked together fraudulently to remove my son . Orleans Parish Civil Court Family and Succession. They're all working together with the system judges, lawyers, opposing spouse. I was threatened with jail time and contempt of court. My son was institutionalized an hour before he was to return home for Sucide thereafter never received treatment.I haven't saw my son in 9 months. Thank you My name is Terrell Richardson and I'm from New Orleans, Louisiana
>
> — TERRELL

> This system has unnecessarily destroyed my relationship with my parents and other extended family. Spreading lies and misinformation, taking my children BECAUSE I DIDNT KNOW ANYBODY TO BE A SAFETY PERSON AND COME TO MY HOME EVERYDAY!
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— RUSSELL

This system has beaten and destroyed the mental health of 6 very healthy people before them. I have had to watch my babies beg me to save them and couldn’t do anything. My son is mad and blamed me for leaving because he doesn’t understand. I went from 2 times a week visits to none at all now. What is the point in living if this is my life now while they just continue living their lives uninterrupted and steadily stealing lives one at a time with no remorse. Psychopaths and serial killers have more compassion for their victims than this state does.

— TIFFANIE NICOLE

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> The last time I saw my daughters was on their first day of preschool and kindergarten, my ex (a bailiff) filed an unjust emergency order. They are now 21 years old and 22 years old.
>
> — AMBER

> The system is completely destroyed my life, my family and daughter. My ex picked up from school on April 17, 2023 and has never slept back in her home with me since then. She was four years old and I have missed every holiday and every school event because I cannot go. This is completely turned my life upside down financially and mentally
>
> — BRITNEY

> As the nonoffending parent, I was deprived of 10 years of a relationship with my son so he could be in Hidden Foster Care. He missed out on entire 1st, 2nd, and 3rd grades because the state did not ensure he was in school. It will have lifelong impacts.
>
> — MICHAEL W.

> I have been marginalized, my due process violated being served orders past a date to object or defend them properly. Court litigation where information was intentionally misrepresented, omitted, pertinent facts unable to be heard that otherwise would have prevented the removal of my infant son from myself and his 2 sisters since 2018 and we haven't seen him in 3 years and counting.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

43 full approved Louisiana comments are included in this appendix.

07 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a public, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Louisiana report comes from Louisiana respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Louisiana — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 67 Louisiana families reporting here are not the universe of Louisiana families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. Response counts and percentages use the number of families who answered that specific topic or financial field. The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – October 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

Dollar fields exclude blank, negative, and obvious data-entry artifact values above the report's field caps. When asset-loss values contain a strong statistical outlier, the asset-loss mean and total are suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county or regional field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

STANDWITHMEG.COM · COURAGE TO STAND, POWER TO CHANGE

ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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